MoodMeals

Eat for how you feel. An emotion-aware meal planning app designed for college students.

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The Hidden Crisis: Student Nutrition & Mental Health

67%

Stress-Eating Students

College students report stress directly affecting their eating habits

3

Common Responses

Skip meals, binge on junk food, or grab whatever's fastest

0

Mood-Aware Apps

Current meal apps don't connect emotional state to nutrition

What if your next meal was designed to fight back against your stress — not add to it?

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The Problem

Current Reality

- Students eat based on convenience, not nutrition
- High-stress periods worsen eating habits exactly when nutrition matters most
- Existing apps only count calories without understanding why you're eating

The Research Gap

Nutritional psychiatry research (SMILES trial, Jacka et al. 2017) proves specific nutrients directly affect mood:

- Magnesium reduces cortisol (stress hormone)
- Tryptophan produces serotonin (mood stabilizer)
- Iron + B12 oxygenate the brain (fights fatigue)

But no consumer app translates this science into actionable meal recommendations.

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Our Solution

01

Analyze Your Mood

AI-powered Gemini pipeline: semantic analysis → clinical mapping → nutrient profiling → meal matching

02

Recommend Clinically-Targeted Meals

Map 5 clinical mood states to specific micronutrients using USDA FoodData Central

03

Predict Stress Before It Hits

Sync with Google Calendar to suggest prep meals 24 hours before exams and deadlines

04

Respect Your Budget

Seattle-specific tips: QFC Wednesday deals, 99 Ranch bulk pricing, Pike Place markdowns

05

Adapt to Your State

Burned out? UI simplifies with fewer choices, quick recipes only, calming interface

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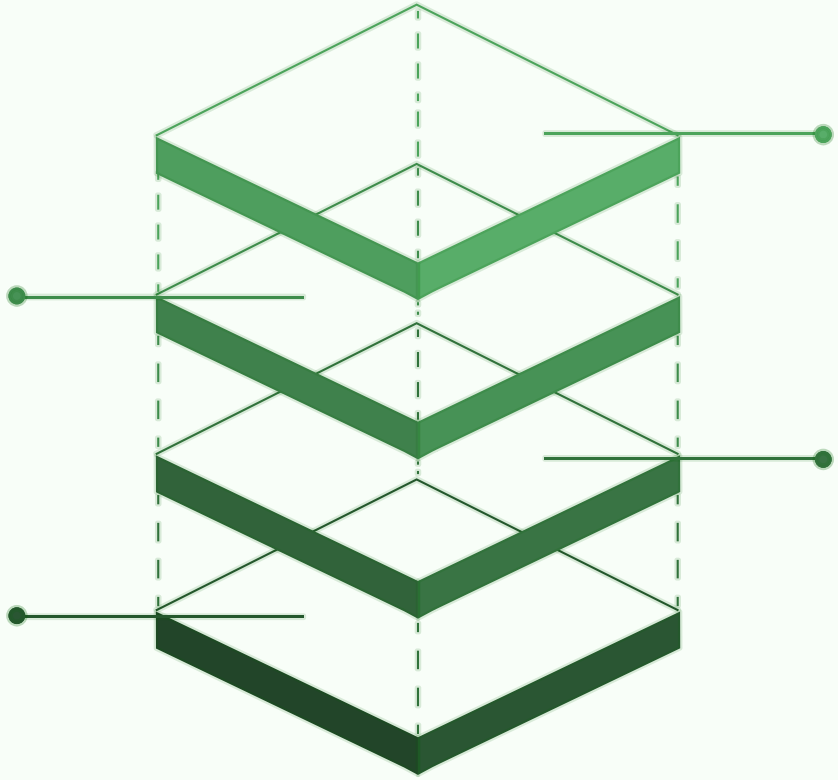
System Architecture



Data Services

USDA + Spoonacular, Google Calendar, Supabase

Gemini AI Pipeline

4-step mood analysis and suggestions

React Context

Shared state and offline fallback

Frontend Layer

MoodInput, MealLibrary, Calendar, Journal components

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Key Features

AI Mood Analysis

"I'm stressed about my thesis" → detects stress → recommends magnesium-rich meals

5 Clinical States

High-stress, cognitive fatigue, depressive, poor focus, burnout — each with targeted nutrients

Adaptive UI

Burnout detected? UI simplifies: fewer choices, quick recipes, breathing exercise

Calendar Sync

Exam tomorrow? Proactive banner: "Try a magnesium-rich dinner tonight"

Budget Tips

Each meal card shows: "Get quinoa at 99 Ranch — 40% cheaper"

Glossary Tooltips

Hover any nutrient term for plain-English explanation

Reflection Loop

"How did this meal make you feel?" → tracks what actually works for YOU

Progress Tracking

Non-punitive milestones — progress only goes up, never backwards

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Live Demo

1

Landing Page

Student-focused messaging: "Built for Northeastern Seattle students"

2

Sign In

Google or guest login with dietary preference and allergy selector

3

Mood Check-In

Type: "Stressed about finals and too tired to cook" → AI detects stress + fatigue

4

Meal Cards

Personalized recommendations with clinical explanations, ingredients, budget tips

5

Calendar

Add exam event → stress intervention banner appears on dashboard

6

Journal

Track mood trends, wellness milestones, and mood-food correlations

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Why MoodMeals Wins

Mood-Aware Nutrition

Not a calorie counter — a clinically-informed nutrition system backed by nutritional psychiatry research

Proactive Intelligence

Predicts stress from your schedule rather than reacting after the fact

No Guilt, No Shame

Non-punitive design with progress that only moves forward

Seattle-Smart

Real store prices and local deals, not generic advice

Dynamic Interface

UI changes based on your mental state for optimal usability

Built with: Next.js 15 | TypeScript | Gemini AI | Supabase | USDA FoodData Central | Google Calendar API | PWA

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Team & Resources

Team

Localhost Legends

Live App

mood-meals-rust.vercel.app

GitHub

github.com/rohanjoshi1399/MoodMeals

> **"Eat for how you feel."**
>
> Your mood drives your meals. Your meals drive your grades. That's MoodMeals.

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Key Takeaways

1 Real Science, Real Impact

Translates nutritional psychiatry research into actionable meal recommendations that combat stress and fatigue

2 AI-Powered Personalization

Gemini analyzes mood, predicts stress from calendar, and adapts interface to your mental state

3 Built for Students, by Students

Seattle-specific budget tips, exam-aware meal planning, and non-punitive progress tracking

Your mood drives your meals. Your meals drive your grades.

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